

PUBLIC ART / 2023 / CHICAGO, IL

Homebound

Leonard Suryajaya, E(art)h Chicago



A CNC cut aluminum collage in Grant Park, built to survive a Chicago spring.

THE WORK

Leonard Suryajaya called it a memorial to our relationship with earth as home. The piece takes its shape from the Maneki-Neko, the lucky cat, and from the deconstructed forms of roadside fruit stands. Three heads emerge from the ground framing the sun path, the lake, and the river, with fruits in disguise scattered around the base like offerings on an altar. It is adorned with familiar eyes and photographic artifacts from the artist's home in Chicago and his hometown in Indonesia.

THE MATERIAL QUESTION

Suryajaya's collages are paper, layered and cut. This one had to stand on the lakefront through a Chicago spring and still read as collage: the eyes legible up close, the layering legible at monument scale, the images surviving wind, sun, and weather for a season outdoors. The problem was carrying a paper language into a material that does not behave like paper.

THE MAKING

We translated the artist's forms into buildable drawings, then CNC cut aluminum sheet and formed it into the heads and the fruit, pieced together as a three dimensional puzzle. Parts were welded and finished for an outdoor site, and the eyes and photographic artifacts were printed across the aluminum surface so the collage lived in the metal rather than on top of it.

IN PLACE

Installed on the lakefront at the north end of the Grant Park waterfront trail, one of twelve pieces supported by E(art)h Chicago across the city. It was an honor to work with a Chicago artist, to build community around this city, and to help bring his work into civic space. We worked with Suryajaya twice over two years, on Homebound and again on Flight of Butterflies.

DETAILS

Year

2023

Location

Chicago, IL

Category

Public Art

Materials

CNC cut aluminum, printed finish

CREDITS

Artist: Leonard Suryajaya

E(art)h Chicago

STUDIO

ChiLab Studio

Chicago, Illinois

Established 2013





05 HOMEBOUND

Bring us a drawing, a model, or a hunch.

THE STUDIO

Specialty material projects for architecture, interior design, public art, and the fine arts.

ChiLab Studio, Chicago, Illinois. Established 2013.

WHAT WE DO

Metal casting

Glass

Finishes

Digital fabrication

Metal fabrication

Restoration

Project management

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